

Chapter 42-5

Liang Shi had slept very well last night and wasn't sleepy at all now.

She played mobile games on her phone.

Halfway through the drive, the car started getting bumpy, waking up everyone in the vehicle. Then everyone started chatting randomly.

All about things happening at the magazine department.

Someone started a topic about the recent Minghui Jewelry.

Especially the launch event on Friday.

"Did you all watch it? Those design sketches were absolutely stunning." A female colleague from the gg group pulled up the concept art from that day, "If I weren't broke, I would have splurged."

"How much does it cost?" Li Ran asked.

"The ring is over 70,000 yuan." The female colleague said.

Li Ran: "That's not too bad, at least it's not as expensive as BARE."

"But BARE has good materials. Minghui's material quality has been declining since three years ago. Some netizens showed that it turned black in less than a month—just a pair of scrap metal." The female colleague said: "But previous years' designs weren't this good-looking. If it were 7,000 yuan, I could splurge based on looks alone."

"Speaking of Minghui, it's quite regrettable. Such a big brand, and it declined just like that." Li Ran sighed.

Another female colleague said: "It's fine, the Sheng family¹ people are back in charge, so they should be able to save it. Their current CEO is just a waste, with no management talent whatsoever. Back when Minghui was so glorious under Old Master Sheng, now his granddaughter has joined the company—I think she can make it work."

Li Ran: "Old Master Sheng's granddaughter? My god, Sheng family people are all geniuses."

"What about Old Master Sheng's daughter then? If she were a genius, how could she let her husband ruin Minghui like that?" The female colleague said.

Li Ran was silent for two seconds, then said very sincerely: "Facial genius also counts as genius... right?"

The female colleagues: "..."

"But speaking of it, Sheng family people really are beautiful." The female colleague passed over her phone, "Universal divine beauty, facial genius. Just holding one launch event and she already has fans online, some fans are even buying Minghui products specifically for her."

Li Ran glanced at it, then glanced again, then looked toward Liang Shi.

Liang Shi cleared her throat softly.

Li Ran returned the phone, then pretended to act as if nothing happened and commented, "No one in the Sheng family has ever grown up ugly. Have you all seen the photos of Sheng Qinglin² circulating online? Incredibly handsome! Even in today's entertainment industry, he'd still crush all those pretty boys."

"..."

So everyone started discussing the entertainment industry.

After the Sheng family topic cooled down, Li Ran secretly sent Liang Shi a message: [Good heavens!]

Liang Shi: [...?]

Li Ran: [Your wife is actually from Minghui Jewelry!]

Liang Shi: "..."

She thought everyone already knew.

Minghui Jewelry might have declined in reputation in the outside world, but among these people who worked in luxury brand circles, it still held significant status.

They might have heard of Minghui Jewelry's great name even when they were still in school.

It might even appear in university coursework.

This little episode quickly passed.

Yuyin Daoist Temple³ was located high up on Yunfeng Mountain—not at the peak, but not far from it either.

They climbed stone steps from the foot of the mountain.

Since it was the weekend, quite a few people had come.

Liang Shi exercised regularly, so her stamina was much better than these people who often sat in offices. Before long, she had walked to the front, walking alongside Big Brother from the production team. Big Brother even secretly asked her about the audition.

She said she hadn't received any news yet.

Big Brother then asked her: "If you pass, won't you be able to act alongside my goddess?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Should be."

Big Brother showed a yearning expression, "So envious."

Liang Shi was infected by his emotion and couldn't help saying: "If there's a chance in the future, I'll call you to be an extra on set."

Big Brother: "...Forget it, I'm too ugly, not suitable."

"Not all actors need to be good-looking." Liang Shi said: "Just extras anyway."

Big Brother was tempted, "Really? Then I'll thank you in advance."

After a while, Big Brother said again: "Xiao Liang⁴, you're really too kind—beautiful and kind-hearted. You'll definitely become hugely popular in the future."

Liang Shi smiled, "Then I'll take your auspicious words."

The mountain climbing process wasn't too troublesome, except Li Ran gave up halfway up the mountain, complaining about why she had the crazy idea to come to a Daoist temple while setting a flag⁵ that she would definitely exercise properly after going back, striving not to be the most embarrassing one next time.

With such a "loudspeaker" along the way, everyone's attention was diverted quite a bit.

They successfully arrived at Yuyin Daoist Temple.

Footnotes: ¹ Sheng family: Xu Qingzhu's maternal family, the original founders of Minghui Jewelry

² Sheng Qinglin: Xu Qingzhu's uncle who died young in a car accident ³ Yuyin Daoist Temple: A

Daoist temple on Yunfeng Mountain where mysterious rituals may have taken place ⁴ Xiao Liang:

"Little Liang" - an affectionate way to address someone younger or junior ⁵ Setting a flag: Internet slang for making a bold declaration that often gets proven wrong